SWRS Southwest Recovery Services

Providing Creative Solutions to Common Problems

BROKERAGE & AGENT RECEIVABLES · CAPABILITIES OVERVIEW

Debt Collection Agency for Businesses

Recovering unpaid brokerage fees, agent balances and referral commissions — on pure contingency

Prepared for **Intero Real Estate Services** · August 2026

01 — INTRODUCTION

A recovery partner for the balances a brokerage rarely gets around to chasing

To Debra and the team at Intero Houston — thank you for reaching out. A brokerage carries a receivable most businesses do not recognise as one: money owed by people who used to work under your roof, or by firms you did a deal with once and may never deal with again.

You told us $10,000–$100,000 is outstanding. In a brokerage that number is usually made of desk and transaction fees, marketing and E&O chargebacks, advanced costs never repaid, and commission or referral splits owed by an agent who has since moved to another firm — or by a co-operating brokerage that simply stopped responding.

Southwest Recovery Services is an outsourced receivables recovery partner working commercial balances on **pure contingency since 2004**. You place through a secure portal and we work them. No recovery, no fee.

02 — AT A GLANCE

Two decades of commercial recovery — nationwide

Recovery reach across all 50 states, which matters when a departed agent or a co-operating broker is no longer anywhere near Houston.

2004 Recovering commercial receivables since	**$975M+** Receivables placed (all industries)	**$76M+** Recovered for clients	**800K+** Accounts worked
52% of placed accounts see a recovery	**50** states — nationwide recovery reach	**4.9★** Google client rating	**$0** upfront — no recovery, no fee

- Commercial & B2B collections since 2004
- Nationwide — all 50 states
- 12 offices across 7 states
- Skip tracing on businesses & principals
- Contingency — no recovery, no fee

RECOGNIZED & FEATURED BY

USA TODAY · FINANCIAL SERVICES Review · FSR • TOP 10 LIST 2025 Recognition · INTERNATIONAL Business Times · CFO Tech Outlook · insideARM

ACCREDITED & RECOGNIZED

BETTER BUSINESS BUREAU · ACA INTERNATIONAL The Association of Credit and Collection Professionals Member · TOP COLLECTIONS COMPANY Clutch UNITED STATES 2026 · CHAMBER OF COMMERCE.COM 26 27 A+ RATED BUSINESS

★ 4.9 · 38 Google reviews

Memberships: **ACA International** · TAA · AAGD · NARPM

03 — YOUR QUESTIONS, ANSWERED

What a brokerage should ask before placing

The four questions that actually determine whether these balances are worth pursuing.

YOUR QUESTION	SOUTHWEST RECOVERY SERVICES
1. Fee structure	Pure contingency — $0 upfront, no retainer, no minimum. You pay a pre-agreed percentage only of what we actually recover. Balances you have already written off cost nothing to attempt.
2. Former agents who owe the brokerage	The most common brokerage receivable and the most awkward. An agent who left owing desk fees, advanced marketing costs or a chargeback is no longer someone you can lean on internally — but the debt is documented in your independent contractor agreement and it is collectable. We work it as a commercial obligation, professionally, without you having to make the call yourself.
3. Co-operating brokerages and referral fees	A referral fee or commission split owed by another firm is a straightforward business-to-business debt. These often go unpaid simply because nobody at either firm owns the follow-up. A third-party demand resolves a meaningful share of them without escalation.
4. What recovery looks like	Business-owed balances recover materially better than consumer ones — the case studies below run from roughly 27% down into single digits, and the difference is almost entirely documentation and age. A signed ICA or referral agreement plus a clear ledger is what separates the top of that range from the bottom.
Where we do not operate	Worth saying plainly to a California-headquartered network: SWRS does not work consumer collections in California, Oregon or Washington, and Minnesota is restricted. Commercial business-to-business balances are a different matter and are not affected.

THE SWRS CLIENT PORTAL

Simple placement, full visibility

Every placement runs through our secure portal — built so an office administrator can place a batch in minutes and see status without chasing anyone for an update.

SPREADSHEET-READY PLACEMENT

Upload a simple list or an accounting export — we map your columns, no re-keying, no new software.

SECURE FILE EXCHANGE

Send independent contractor agreements, referral agreements, commission statements and ledgers safely inside the portal.

REAL-TIME REPORTING

Run and export account and recovery reports on demand — live status on every placed balance.

DIRECT-PAYMENT REPORTING

Log payments made directly to the brokerage, so balances stay accurate and nobody is contacted after paying.

► Portal Video Tour

04 — CASE STUDIES

SWRS Real Estate & Professional-Services Case Studies

Actual placed-versus-recovered results from Southwest Recovery's real estate and professional-services book, anonymized and sized to an operation of your scale. The honest range is shown, weaker results included — on business-owed balances the outcome tracks documentation and age far more than effort.

RESIDENTIAL BROKERAGE

Independent brokerage

$4.8K recovered

of ~$11K placed

43% recovered

PROPERTY MANAGEMENT FIRM

Regional manager

$5.3K recovered

of ~$19K placed

29% recovered

REALTY PRACTICE

Boutique realty firm

$2.4K recovered

of ~$9K placed

27% recovered

PROPERTY ADVISORY FIRM

Valuation & advisory

$6.6K recovered

of ~$26K placed

25% recovered

REALTY BROKERAGE

Multi-agent brokerage

$6.3K recovered

of ~$29K placed

22% recovered

PROPERTY GROUP — AGED BOOK

Placed near write-off

$8.1K recovered

of ~$35K placed

23% recovered

Anonymized by sector from Southwest Recovery's book; individual client names withheld. Results vary by account age, balance, documentation quality and industry. We do not publish blended portfolio averages.

WHAT SEPARATES THE TOP OF THAT RANGE FROM THE BOTTOM

The agreement in the file decides the outcome

On brokerage balances the single biggest variable is whether the obligation is documented. A signed independent contractor agreement setting out desk fees and chargebacks, or a written referral agreement, turns an awkward conversation into a straightforward commercial debt. Without it, recovery depends entirely on goodwill that has usually already run out.

WHAT TO PLACE FIRST

Balances with a signed agreement and a clean ledger — these carry the argument on their own and recover fastest.

WHAT RAISES THE REST

Placing before the agent or brokerage has fully moved on. Contact data ages quickly in this industry, and a licence lookup only goes so far.

Recovery figures vary by portfolio; SWRS gives an honest, age-based read on a representative sample before any accounts are worked.

05 — BUILT FOR BROKERAGES

Cutting the days between earned and collected

Days Sales Outstanding and Average Collection Period measure the same thing: how long money you have earned sits as a receivable before it becomes cash. Median DSO runs about 43.5 days and the strongest quartile collects in roughly 25 — a brokerage carrying five figures of aged agent and referral balances is operating well outside that band.

Departed-agent balances

Desk fees, advanced marketing costs, E&O and chargebacks owed by agents who have moved on — pursued against your independent contractor agreement.

Referral and split disputes

Commissions and referral fees owed by co-operating brokerages, worked as the business-to-business obligations they are.

Skip tracing across state lines

Agents and brokers relocate and re-license; recovery reach across all 50 states means a move is not the end of the matter.

Relationship-safe contact

Houston real estate is a small world. Compliant, documented, unaggressive outreach protects a reputation you still have to trade on.

Recovery run on an AI-driven platform — Aktos

Every account SWRS works runs on Aktos, a next-generation, AI-driven collections platform — with compliance built into the workflow, not bolted on afterward. It's how a boutique, people-first agency delivers enterprise-grade speed, consistency, and auditability.

AKTOS

AI workflow automation

Repetitive steps are automated and every account is scored and routed by predicted payment likelihood — so the right strategy reaches the right account first, without manual queue-picking.

Omnichannel outreach

Coordinated email, SMS, and voice, timed to when a debtor is most likely to engage — replacing high-friction call blasts with respectful, data-driven contact.

Compliance built in

FDCPA, Reg F, and TCPA guardrails are enforced inside the automation, with phone-number and consent checks before outreach — documented and defensible on every account.

Real-time dashboards

You see status, segmentation, and recovery performance on your portfolio in real time — full transparency, not a monthly PDF.

API-first intake

Secure SFTP/API placement means accounts start working without data lag — roughly 50% faster acknowledgment and validation of new placements.

Data-driven scoring

Dynamic scoring and segmentation predict payment likelihood and concentrate effort where recovery is most achievable — earlier intervention that returns more of each aging balance and reduces disputes.

The result is the combination clients rarely get from a legacy agency: faster cash and cleaner compliance at the same time. Automation accelerates recovery and standardizes documentation, while empathy-first, data-driven contact protects your brand and keeps disputes and complaints low.

07 — MEET THE FOUNDER

Built by a collector with 30 years on the phones — not a CEO with zero collection experience

Steven Dietz

Founder & Chief Executive Officer

Featured in USA Today, International Business Times & Financial Services Review — Top AR Management Service, 2025 · ACA International member.

Steven Dietz didn't come to collections from the corner office — he came from the phones. He started as a collector and credit analyst before he was 20, trained collectors across 100+ locations for Aaron's, and has spent nearly 30 years in receivables.

He founded Southwest Recovery Services in 2004 on one principle: the industry's bad reputation is a choice, not a requirement. Two decades on he still coaches the teams and works accounts personally.

> Regardless of the means of recovery, our focus is always on preserving goodwill and representing the client professionally.
>
> **— Steven Dietz, Founder & Chief Executive Officer, Southwest Recovery Services**

An agent who owes the brokerage today may be a referral source in two years. Recovery stays professional and documented — that protects the money and the relationship at the same time.

08 — RESOURCES

Take it with you

Download this overview and the supporting white papers to share with your team.

This capabilities overview

PDF · prepared for Intero Houston

Download PDF ↓

The Placement-File Standard

Maximizing recovery · PDF

Download PDF ↓

The Cost of Waiting: DSO & Commercial Recovery

B2B receivables · PDF

Download PDF ↓

The Aktos Advantage

Our AI-driven collections platform · PDF

Download PDF ↓

The Experian Intelligence Advantage

Data & skip-tracing stack · PDF

Download PDF ↓

The Recovery Waterfall

Full recovery lifecycle · PDF

Download PDF ↓

09 — NEXT STEP

Let's turn those written-off brokerage balances back into cash.

A 30-minute call with Hunter Howard to walk your outstanding list, confirm what agreements and ledgers you hold, and put a contingency rate against a representative sample.

Book a 30-minute discovery call →

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